

Appendix A: Self-assessment form

This self-assessment form should be completed by the complaints officer and it must be reviewed and approved by the landlord's governing body at least annually.

Once approved, landlords must publish the self-assessment as part of the annual complaints performance and service improvement report on their website. The governing body's response to the report must be published alongside this.

Landlords are required to complete the self-assessment in full and support all statements with evidence, with additional commentary as necessary.

We recognise that there may be a small number of circumstances where landlords are unable to meet the requirements, for example, if they do not have a website. In these circumstances, we expect landlords to deliver the intentions of the Code in an alternative way, for example by publishing information in a public area so that it is easily accessible.

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Section 1: Definition of a complaint

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
1.2	A complaint must be defined as: <i>'an expression of dissatisfaction, however made, about the standard of service, actions or lack of action by the landlord, its own staff, or those acting on its behalf, affecting a resident or group of residents.'</i>	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
1.3	A resident does not have to use the word 'complaint' for it to be treated as such. Whenever a resident expresses dissatisfaction landlords must give them the choice to make complaint. A complaint that is submitted via a third party or representative must be handled in line with the landlord's complaints policy.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	

1.4	Landlords must recognise the difference between a service request and a complaint. This must be set out in their complaints policy. A service request is a request from a resident to the landlord requiring action to be taken to put something right. Service requests are not complaints, but must be recorded, monitored and reviewed regularly.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
1.5	A complaint must be raised when the resident expresses dissatisfaction with the response to their service request, even if the handling of the service request remains ongoing. Landlords must not stop their efforts to address the service request if the resident complains.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
1.6	An expression of dissatisfaction with services made through a survey is not defined as a complaint, though wherever possible, the person completing the survey should be made aware of how they can pursue a complaint if they wish to. Where landlords ask for wider feedback about their services, they also must provide details of how residents can complain.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

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Section 2: Exclusions

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
2.1	Landlords must accept a complaint unless there is a valid reason not to do so. If landlords decide not to accept a complaint they must be able to evidence their reasoning. Each complaint must be considered on its own merits	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
	A complaints policy must set out the			

	circumstances in which a matter will not be considered as a complaint or escalated, and these circumstances must be fair and reasonable to residents. Acceptable exclusions include: • The issue giving rise to the complaint occurred over twelve months ago. • Legal proceedings have started. This is defined as details of the claim, such as the Claim Form and Particulars of Claim, having been filed at court. • Matters that have previously been considered under the complaints policy.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
2.2	Landlords must accept complaints referred to them within 12 months of the issue occurring or the resident becoming aware of the issue, unless they are excluded on other grounds. Landlords must consider whether to apply discretion to accept complaints made outside this time limit where there are good reasons to do so.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
2.3	If a landlord decides not to accept a complaint, an explanation must be provided to the resident setting out the reasons why the matter is not suitable for the complaints process and the right to take that decision to the Ombudsman. If the Ombudsman does not agree that the exclusion has been fairly applied, the Ombudsman may tell the landlord to take on the complaint.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
2.4	Landlords must not take a blanket approach to excluding complaints; they must consider the individual circumstances of each complaint.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
2.5			

□Section 3: Accessibility and Awareness

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
3.1	Landlords must make it easy for residents to complain by providing different channels through which they can make a complaint. Landlords must consider their duties under the Equality Act 2010 and anticipate the needs and reasonable adjustments of residents who may need to access the complaints process.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	During the reporting period, a total of four complaints were received. While this is a low volume, the Board recognises that this may indicate that complaints are not consistently identified or recorded in line with the Housing Ombudsman's Complaint Handling Code.
3.2	Residents must be able to raise their complaints in any way and with any member of staff. All staff must be aware of the complaints process and be able to pass details of the complaint to the appropriate person within the landlord.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	The organisation acknowledges the need to strengthen staff awareness of complaint recognition, particularly ensuring that all staff understand that an expression of dissatisfaction, however made, must be treated as a complaint. This will be addressed through enhanced training and embedding complaint recognition within staff induction processes.
3.3	High volumes of complaints must not be seen as a negative, as they can be indicative of a well-publicised and accessible complaints process. Low complaint volumes are potentially a sign that residents are unable to complain.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
3.4	Landlords must make their complaint policy available in a clear and accessible format for all residents. This will detail the two stage process, what will happen at each stage, and the timeframes for	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications;	

responding. The policy must also be published on the landlord's website.

website publication of policy and process.

3.5

The policy must explain how the landlord will publicise details of the complaints policy, including information about the Ombudsman and this Code.

Yes

Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

3.6

Landlords must give residents the opportunity to have a representative deal with their complaint on their behalf, and to be represented or accompanied at any meeting with the landlord.

Yes

Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

3.7

Landlords must provide residents with information on their right to access the Ombudsman service and how the individual can engage with the Ombudsman about their complaint.

Yes

Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

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Section 4: Complaint Handling Staff

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
4.1	Landlords must have a person or team assigned to take responsibility for complaint handling, including liaison with the Ombudsman and ensuring complaints are reported to the governing body (or equivalent). This Code will refer to that person or team as the 'complaints officer'. This role may be in addition to other duties.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
		Yes		The Board promotes a positive complaints culture and recognises that complaint handling is a core service.

4.2	The complaints officer must have access to staff at all levels to facilitate the prompt resolution of complaints. They must also have the authority and autonomy to act to resolve disputes promptly and fairly.		Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	Trustees have identified the need to strengthen formal training for all staff to ensure consistent recognition, recording, and handling of complaints in line with the Complaint Handling Code. This includes a commitment to embed complaint handling training, including the requirements of the Code, within induction processes for all new staff, as well as refresher training for existing staff.
4.3	Landlords are expected to prioritise complaint handling and a culture of learning from complaints. All relevant staff must be suitably trained in the importance of complaint handling. It is important that complaints are seen as a core service and must be resourced to handle complaints effectively	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	

Section 5: The Complaint Handling Process

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
5.1	Landlords must have a single policy in place for dealing with complaints covered by this Code. Residents must not be treated differently if they complain.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
5.2	The early and local resolution of issues between landlords and residents is key to effective complaint handling. It is not appropriate to have extra named stages (such as 'stage 0' or 'informal complaint') as this causes unnecessary confusion.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
	A process with more than two stages is not acceptable under any circumstances	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board	

5.3	as this will make the complaint process unduly long and delay access to the Ombudsman.		reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.4	Where a landlord's complaint response is handled by a third party (e.g. a contractor or independent adjudicator) at any stage, it must form part of the two stage complaints process set out in this Code. Residents must not be expected to go through two complaints processes.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.5	Landlords are responsible for ensuring that any third parties handle complaints in line with the Code.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.6	When a complaint is logged at Stage 1 or escalated to Stage 2, landlords must set out their understanding of the complaint and the outcomes the resident is seeking. The Code will refer to this as "the complaint definition". If any aspect of the complaint is unclear, the resident must be asked for clarification.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.7	When a complaint is acknowledged at either stage, landlords must be clear which aspects of the complaint they are, and are not, responsible for and clarify any areas where this is not clear.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.8	At each stage of the complaints process, complaint handlers must: a. deal with complaints on their merits, act independently, and have an open mind; b. give the resident a fair chance to set out their position; c. take measures to address any actual or perceived conflict of interest; and d. consider all relevant information and evidence carefully.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

5.9	Where a response to a complaint will fall outside the timescales set out in this Code, the landlord must agree with the resident suitable intervals for keeping them informed about their complaint.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.10	Landlords must make reasonable adjustments for residents where appropriate under the Equality Act 2010. Landlords must keep a record of any reasonable adjustments agreed, as well as a record of any disabilities a resident has disclosed. Any agreed reasonable adjustments must be kept under active review.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.11	Landlords must not refuse to escalate a complaint through all stages of the complaints procedure unless it has valid reasons to do so. Landlords must clearly set out these reasons, and they must comply with the provisions set out in section 2 of this Code.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.12	A full record must be kept of the complaint, and the outcomes at each stage. This must include the original complaint and the date received, all correspondence with the resident, correspondence with other parties, and any relevant supporting documentation such as reports or surveys.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.13	Landlords must have processes in place to ensure a complaint can be remedied at any stage of its complaints process. Landlords must ensure appropriate remedies can be provided at any stage of the complaints process without the need for escalation.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
5.14	Landlords must have policies and procedures in place for managing unacceptable behaviour from residents and/or their representatives. Landlords must be able to evidence reasons for putting any restrictions in place and must keep restrictions under regular review.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

5.15	Any restrictions placed on contact due to unacceptable behaviour must be proportionate and demonstrate regard for the provisions of the Equality Act 2010.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
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Section 6: Complaints Stages

Stage 1

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
6.1	Landlords must have processes in place to consider which complaints can be responded to as early as possible, and which require further investigation. Landlords must consider factors such as the complexity of the complaint and whether the resident is vulnerable or at risk. Most stage 1 complaints can be resolved promptly, and an explanation, apology or resolution provided to the resident.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.2	Complaints must be acknowledged, defined and logged at stage 1 of the complaints procedure <u>within five working days of the complaint being received.</u>	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.3	Landlords must issue a full response to stage 1 complaints <u>within 10 working days</u> of the complaint being acknowledged.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.4	Landlords must decide whether an extension to this timescale is needed when considering the complexity of the complaint and then inform the resident of the expected timescale for response. Any	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance	

	extension must be no more than 10 working days without good reason, and the reason(s) must be clearly explained to the resident.		monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.5	When an organisation informs a resident about an extension to these timescales, they must be provided with the contact details of the Ombudsman.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.6	A complaint response must be provided to the resident when the answer to the complaint is known, not when the outstanding actions required to address the issue are completed. Outstanding actions must still be tracked and actioned promptly with appropriate updates provided to the resident.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.7	Landlords must address all points raised in the complaint definition and provide clear reasons for any decisions, referencing the relevant policy, law and good practice where appropriate.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.8	Where residents raise additional complaints during the investigation, these must be incorporated into the stage 1 response if they are related and the stage 1 response has not been issued. Where the stage 1 response has been issued, the new issues are unrelated to the issues already being investigated or it would unreasonably delay the response, the new issues must be logged as a new complaint.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.9	Landlords must confirm the following in writing to the resident at the completion of stage 1 in clear, plain language: a. the complaint stage; b. the complaint definition; c. the decision on the complaint; d. the reasons for any decisions made; e. the details of any remedy offered to put things right;	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and

- f. details of any outstanding actions; and
- g. details of how to escalate the matter to stage 2 if the individual is not satisfied with the response.

process.

Stage 2

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
6.10	If all or part of the complaint is not resolved to the resident's satisfaction at stage 1, it must be progressed to stage 2 of the landlord's procedure. Stage 2 is the landlord's final response.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.11	Requests for stage 2 must be acknowledged, defined and logged at stage 2 of the complaints procedure within five working days of the escalation request being received.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.12	Residents must not be required to explain their reasons for requesting a stage 2 consideration. Landlords are expected to make reasonable efforts to understand why a resident remains unhappy as part of its stage 2 response.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.13	The person considering the complaint at stage 2 must not be the same person that considered the complaint at stage 1.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
6.14	Landlords must issue a final response to the stage 2 <u>within 20 working days</u> of the complaint being acknowledged.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	

6.15	Landlords must decide whether an extension to this timescale is needed when considering the complexity of the complaint and then inform the resident of the expected timescale for response. Any extension must be no more than 20 working days without good reason, and the reason(s) must be clearly explained to the resident.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.16	When an organisation informs a resident about an extension to these timescales, they must be provided with the contact details of the Ombudsman.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.17	A complaint response must be provided to the resident when the answer to the complaint is known, not when the outstanding actions required to address the issue are completed. Outstanding actions must still be tracked and actioned promptly with appropriate updates provided to the resident.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.18	Landlords must address all points raised in the complaint definition and provide clear reasons for any decisions, referencing the relevant policy, law and good practice where appropriate.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
6.19	Landlords must confirm the following in writing to the resident at the completion of stage 2 in clear, plain language: a. the complaint stage; b. the complaint definition; c. the decision on the complaint; d. the reasons for any decisions made; e. the details of any remedy offered to put things right; f. details of any outstanding actions; and g. details of how to escalate the matter to the Ombudsman if the individual remains dissatisfied.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

Service

6.20	Stage 2 is the landlord's final response and must involve all suitable staff members needed to issue such a response.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
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Section 7: Putting things right

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
7.1	Where something has gone wrong a landlord must acknowledge this and set out the actions it has already taken, or intends to take, to put things right. These can include: • Apologising; • Acknowledging where things have gone wrong; • Providing an explanation, assistance or reasons; • Taking action if there has been delay; • Reconsidering or changing a decision; • Amending a record or adding a correction or addendum; • Providing a financial remedy; • Changing policies, procedures or practices.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
7.2	Any remedy offered must reflect the impact on the resident as a result of any fault identified.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
7.3	The remedy offer must clearly set out what will happen and by when, in agreement with the resident where appropriate. Any remedy proposed must be followed through to completion.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	

7.4	Landlords must take account of the guidance issued by the Ombudsman when deciding on appropriate remedies.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
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Section 8: Self-assessment, reporting and compliance

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
8.1	Landlords must produce an annual complaints performance and service improvement report for scrutiny and challenge, which must include: a. the annual self-assessment against this Code to ensure their complaint handling policy remains in line with its requirements. b. a qualitative and quantitative analysis of the landlord's complaint handling performance. This must also include a summary of the types of complaints the landlord has refused to accept; c. any findings of non-compliance with this Code by the Ombudsman; d. the service improvements made as a result of the learning from complaints; e. any annual report about the landlord's performance from the Ombudsman; and f. any other relevant reports or publications produced by the Ombudsman in relation to the work of the landlord.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	The Board maintains oversight of complaints handling through quarterly reporting on complaint volumes, trends, compliance with timescales, and outcomes. The Member Responsible for Complaints (MRC), supported by a Trustee, provides additional scrutiny through regular engagement with the Chief Executive Officer and senior leadership team. The Board reviews the annual self-assessment against the Complaint Handling Code, approves updates to the Complaints Policy, and considers emerging risks and learning from complaints. This governance framework ensures compliance with the Code and supports continuous service improvement.
8.2	The annual complaints performance and service improvement report must be reported to the landlord's governing body (or equivalent) and published on the on the section of its website relating to complaints. The governing body's response to the report must be published	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	The Trustees' formal response to complaints performance, including identified areas for improvement, is published alongside this self-assessment in line with the requirements of the Complaint Handling Code.

alongside this.

8.3	Landlords must also carry out a self-assessment following a significant restructure, merger and/or change in procedures.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
8.4	Landlords may be asked to review and update the self-assessment following an Ombudsman investigation.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
8.5	If a landlord is unable to comply with the Code due to exceptional circumstances, such as a cyber incident, they must inform the Ombudsman, provide information to residents who may be affected, and publish this on their website Landlords must provide a timescale for returning to compliance with the Code.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

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Section 9: Scrutiny & oversight: continuous learning and improvement

Code provision	Code requirement	Comply: Yes / No	Evidence	Commentary / explanation
9.1	Landlords must look beyond the circumstances of the individual complaint and consider whether service improvements can be made as a result of any learning from the complaint.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
		Yes		The Board is committed to using complaints as a source of learning to improve service delivery. Complaint performance, themes, and learning outcomes are reviewed quarterly to ensure

			transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement.
			Trustees recognise that low complaint volumes may indicate barriers to reporting and are taking steps to strengthen accessibility and awareness.
9.2	A positive complaint handling culture is integral to the effectiveness with which landlords resolve disputes. Landlords must use complaints as a source of intelligence to identify issues and introduce positive changes in service delivery.		Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process. Identified improvement actions include: • Strengthening staff training in complaint recognition and handling • Improving engagement with Tenant Representatives to support awareness and feedback • Enhancing staff capability to respond to tenant needs, including compliance with Awaab's Law in relation to damp and mould Progress against these actions is monitored by the Board to ensure that learning from complaints is embedded across the organisation.
9.3	Accountability and transparency are also integral to a positive complaint handling culture. Landlords must report back on wider learning and improvements from complaints to stakeholders, such as residents' panels, staff and relevant committees.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.
9.4	Landlords must appoint a suitably senior lead person as accountable for their complaint handling. This person must assess any themes or trends to identify potential systemic issues, serious risks, or policies and procedures that require revision.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.

9.5	In addition to this a member of the governing body (or equivalent) must be appointed to have lead responsibility for complaints to support a positive complaint handling culture. This person is referred to as the Member Responsible for Complaints ('the MRC').	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	A Member Responsible for Complaints (MRC) has been appointed to provide assurance to the Board on complaints handling performance. The MRC, supported by a Trustee, receives regular updates on complaint volumes, categories, outcomes, and compliance with timescales, and reports these to the Board. This ensures effective scrutiny, identification of trends, and oversight of service improvements arising from complaints.
9.6	The MRC will be responsible for ensuring the governing body receives regular information on complaints that provides insight on the landlord's complaint handling performance. This person must have access to suitable information and staff to perform this role and report on their findings.	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
9.7	As a minimum, the MRC and the governing body (or equivalent) must receive: a. regular updates on the volume, categories and outcomes of complaints, alongside complaint handling performance; b. regular reviews of issues and trends arising from complaint handling; c. regular updates on the outcomes of the Ombudsman's investigations and progress made in complying with orders related to severe maladministration findings; and d. annual complaints performance and service improvement report. Landlords must have a standard objective in relation to complaint handling for all relevant employees or third parties that reflects the need to: a. have a collaborative and co-operative approach towards resolving complaints,	Yes	Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff training records; complaints log; board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications; website publication of policy and process.	
			Complaints Policy; Complaint Handling Code self-assessment; staff	

9.8 working with colleagues across teams and departments;
b. take collective responsibility for any shortfalls identified through complaints, rather than blaming others; and
c. act within the professional standards for engaging with complaints as set by any relevant professional body.

Yes training records; complaints log;
board reports; quarterly performance monitoring; resident communications;
website publication of policy and process.